

3.3 Political ideas

3.3.1 Core ideologies

3.3.1.1 Liberalism

Key concepts and terminology:

- the individual and freedom
- human nature, the state, society and the economy
- classical liberalism
- modern liberalism.

Focus

Students should analyse and evaluate:

- debates about the nature of liberalism
- core liberal ideas and values concerning the individual and freedom
- classical liberalism, modern (new/progressive) liberalism
- in their study of the following thinkers students should focus on the aspects indicated after each thinker's name and relate this to liberal thinking on human nature, the state, society and the economy:
 - John Locke – natural rights, liberty and individualism, fiduciary power of government
 - John Stuart Mill – criticism of hedonism, freedom, integrity and self respect of the individual, self regarding and other regarding actions
 - John Rawls – concept of justice, principles of justice
 - Thomas Hill Green – self development/role of the State, negative and positive freedom
 - Mary Wollstonecraft – equality and rights, 'revolution controversy', criticisms of aristocracy and republicanism
 - Betty Friedan – equal rights, Civil Rights and feminist movements in the USA.

3.3.1.2 Conservatism

Key concepts and terminology:

- government, the free market, the individual
- authority, tradition, private property human nature, the state, society and the economy
- traditional conservatism
- the new right.

Focus

Students should analyse and evaluate:

- debates about the nature of conservatism
- core conservative ideas and values concerning government, the free market and the individual
- different strands of conservative thinking from traditional Conservatism to the New Right
- in their study of the following thinkers students should focus on the aspects indicated after each thinker's name and relate this to conservative thinking on human nature, the state, society and the economy:
 - Thomas Hobbes – concept of human nature/laws of nature, power of the sovereign/the individual and self protection
 - Edmund Burke – Anti-Jacobinism/Whig principles, Burke's reaction to the American and French Revolutions
 - Michael Oakeshott – importance of tradition/criticisms of rationalism, 'Politics of Faith' vs 'Politics of Scepticism'
 - Ayn Rand – opposition to collectivism and statism, rational and ethical egoism/individual rights
 - Robert Nozick – limited functions of the State, justification of inequalities of wealth resulting from freely exchanged contracts.

3.3.1.3 Socialism

Key concepts and terminology:

- Marxism, class analysis and fundamental goals of socialism
- human nature, the state, society and the economy
- revolutionary socialism
- social democracy.

Focus

Students should analyse and evaluate:

- debates about the nature of socialism
- core socialist views and values concerning Marxism, class analysis and the fundamental goals of socialism
- differing views and tensions within and between revolutionary socialism and social democracy
- in their study of the following thinkers students should focus on the aspects indicated after each thinker's name and relate this to socialist thinking on human nature, the state, society and the economy:
 - Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels – class and class struggle, dialectical materialism
 - Rosa Luxemburg – inevitability of the triumph of revolution/capacity of the masses, spontaneity/party oriented class struggle
 - Beatrice Webb – co-operative movement, co-operative federalism and co-operative individualism
 - Anthony Crosland – criticism of Marxism/Revisionism, rejection of nationalisation as central goal of party, political values of personal liberty, social welfare and equality
 - Anthony Giddens – rejection of traditional conception of socialism, the 'Third Way' in politics, combination of right wing economic and left wing social policies.